

Chapter 25-2

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On the other side of this city, Liang Shi sat in the living room turning her phone around.

The living room had only one night light on, making the vast space appear empty.

But it was conducive to thinking.

She sent a text to Cheng Ran but got no reply, and when she called, it went straight to busy signal.

She could guess the answer.

She didn't even need to ask for the reason.

For people like Cheng Ran and her group, as long as the mood struck them, they would even play themselves to death, let alone others.

Just like the incidents that Huayue International covered up every year - countless.

Although Zhao Xuning could threaten a powerless manager, saying she could use media power to expose Huayue International's affairs, which would cause Huayue International's reputation to plummet overnight and potentially evaporate billions in stock market value.

But the cost of doing so would be enormous.

The power of capital was sometimes unshakeable precisely because pulling one thread would affect the whole body¹.

Liang Shi looking for Cheng Ran was just to say that if there were any problems in the future, she could come directly to her.

She would accompany her to the end, rather than going after Xu Qingzhu.

Taking over the original owner's body also meant taking over her mess.

Even the chain reactions caused by her own OOC² behavior, she would bear the consequences together.

Liang Shi had been mentally prepared for this.

The most troublesome thing was that she was isolated and helpless here.

Like what happened tonight, she was too passive and couldn't do anything.

Standing in the corridor of Huayue International, she suddenly realized that in such an environment, she couldn't protect the people she wanted to protect.

This was her first time stepping into high society, and only then did she realize that even wealthy families had hierarchies.

In the face of sufficiently powerful authority, money was just so-so.

This was a world completely different from her previous living environment.

She was about to witness a reality more cruel than the entertainment industry.

She had always disliked involving other people.

This would make her feel guilty and remorseful.

Perhaps it was related to her childhood experiences - she had never truly protected someone with all her heart.

For her, being able to protect herself was already difficult enough.

In the dog-eat-dog entertainment industry, she was able to climb up from the bottom and be nominated for Best Actress.

This was not unrelated to her ability to take care of herself.

It wasn't that she lacked compassion or sympathy, but under circumstances where she could barely protect herself, those were all meaningless.

She had always had boundaries.

But with Xu Qingzhu, she was slightly losing her boundaries.

This might also be related to her just arriving here and not yet being familiar with the environment.

Footnotes:

¹ "Pulling one thread affects the whole body" (牵一发而动全身) - A Chinese idiom meaning that a small change can affect the entire situation.

² OOC - "Out of Character" - refers to acting differently from one's usual personality or expected behavior.